

Specifications for HTML5 creatives

HTML5 creatives are a type of display creative with their own specific recommendations, sourced from the [IAB Display Advertising Guidelines](#). HTML5 creatives are displayed as a full HTML page in an iFrame.



Tip

Want a PDF version of the creative specifications? Download it from our [website](#).

Here's what you need to know about HTML5 creatives:

- You may not use [dynamic](#) or [expandable](#) creatives as HTML5 creatives.
- Different browsers have different subsets of HTML5 features enabled. Your creative might fail on a browser if it attempts to use a feature that is not enabled in the browser. It is your responsibility to ensure that your creative “gracefully degrades” in case the browser it is viewed on doesn’t support the features it uses.
- The IAB recommends adding the dimensions of your creative to your primary HTML document in a meta tag inside of the `<head>` section of your document. Here's an example, in which you'd replace the `width` and `height` values with the actual dimensions of your creative:

```
<meta name="ad.size" content="width=300,height=250"/>
```



If an `ad.size` meta tag is not provided in the primary HTML document, you are prompted to enter dimensions when you submit the creative.

- The Trade Desk Hosted HTML5 system requires that you upload a static backup image. This image is used to display the ad if a user has JavaScript disabled.
- [Commonly used JavaScript and CSS libraries](#) (such as jQuery) do not need to be included with the creative.
- Including [image sprites](#) instead of multiple images decreases the number of file requests made by your creative and increases its performance.

- Avoid the use of video tags in HTML5.
- Audio tags should play only if a user intentionally starts the audio.

For details on this creative type, see [HTML5 For Digital Advertising: Guidance for Ad Designers and Creative Technologists](#).

File sizes

The following table lists the supported file sizes for HTML5 creatives. For additional requirements, see File packaging.

Requirement	Maximum specification
Initial load	300 KB (200 KB recommended)
Subload	600 KB
Initial file load count	10 files
Subload file count	100 files
File size	5 MB
User-initiated load	2.2 MB (recommended)

File packaging

You can use one of the following packaging options:

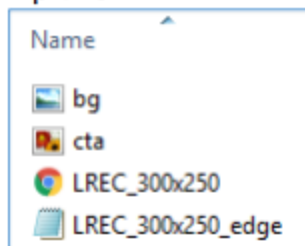
- A single HTML file.
All information for serving the creative (with the exception of commonly used JavaScript and CSS libraries) should be included in the HTML file. The maximum HTML file size is 200 KB.
- A single root/main HTML file with supporting images.
- A single root/main HTML file with supporting images and additional supporting JS and CSS files.

Here's what you need to know about using compressed (ZIP) files:

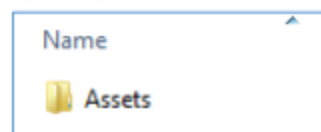
- All files for displaying the creative (with the exception of commonly used JavaScript and CSS libraries) should be included in the ZIP file.
- The primary HTML file should be located in the root of the ZIP file.

- ZIP files must contain no more than 100 files, including at least one HTML file for use as the initiating file for display. Keep the file count low to minimize browser performance impact.
- You can include only HTML, JS, CSS, MP4, JPG, JPEG, GIF, PNG, and SVG files in a ZIP file.
- When packaging HTML5 creatives, include the asset files, not the folder containing them, in the ZIP file:

Zip this:



Not this:



The following table lists the maximum file size requirements for compressed files. See also File sizes.

Requirement	Maximum size
Automatically-started video	Less than 1.1 MB
Any individual file	2.2 MB
Primary HTML file	100 KB
ZIP file compressed	Less than 10 MB
ZIP file uncompressed	Less than 12 MB

Click tag parameters

A click tag is a parameter used in HTML5 banner ads. The parameter is a variable that defines the destination URL and is provided in the primary HTML file as a URL parameter.

Here's what you need to know about click tag parameters:

- You can customize the name of the URL parameter when uploading or editing the creative.

- Click tag names are case-sensitive. Be sure to use uniform capitalization throughout the creative and any supporting files. For example, `clickTag` and `clickTAG` are not interchangeable. The Trade Desk Platform defaults to `clickTAG`.
- When the user clicks the ad, the creative must direct the user to the correct click tag page in a new window.
- If you want to also use that clickthrough URL in your HTML5 creative, you can configure the creative to use the backup clickthrough URL as the default clickthrough URL.

To call the clickthrough page through the backup ad image correctly, you must supply a clickthrough parameter.

- You can use multiple click-through URLs and define different landing pages for different actions.

If you append a URL-escaped landing page to the click tag URL, the platform tracks the click and redirects the request to the given landing page.

```
var clickTAG = getParameterByName("clickTAG") +  
encodeURIComponent("http://www.thetradedesk.com");
```



Tip

Use JavaScript to read the parameter from the document location URL and use it to set up the landing page for your clicks. You can use either all single quotes (') or all double quotes (") in your code, but you cannot mix them.

Example 1. A click tag parameter example

The following code block shows one way to retrieve and implement a creative with a clickthrough URL that has been specified in The Trade Desk platform. In this example, a single image is wrapped with an anchor tag, which, when clicked, opens a new window with the address stored in the `clickTAG` URL parameter of the creative.



```
<html>
<head>
  <script type="text/javascript" charset="utf-8">
    function getParameterByName(name) { 1
      // Returns the value of URL parameter "name"
      name = name.replace(/\[/, "\\[").replace(/\]/, "\\]");
      var regex = new RegExp("\\?&" + name + "=(^&#)*)",
        results = regex.exec(location.search);
      return results === null
        ? ""
        : decodeURIComponent(results[1].replace(/\+/g, " "));
    }
    var clickTAG = getParameterByName("clickTAG");
    2
  </script>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="javascript:window.open(window.clickTAG);void(0);">
    
  </a>
</body>
</html>
```

- 1** This function retrieves the `clickTAG` parameter.
- 2** The location where the value for the clickthrough URL should be stored in the `window.clickTAG` variable.

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English